Interview summary: exp_003

(Former P_02 in the focus group)

Fairness

Q: Does the implementation decision described in the statements involve an ethically relevant consideration?

All the scenarios describe a “moral dilemma”. The last one (F4) is the best scenario because it explains why it would make sense to implement the function. Others might require more explicit description to justify the need of making a choice

Q: Do the statements primarily reflect the intended ethical aspect, rather than the others?

Yes

Q: Do the alternative implementation choices in the scenarios differ meaningfully in the extent to which they reflect the ethical aspect?

Yes, but I am not fully convinced about the options of F4. The “without prioritizing any group” may influence the choice. I’d keep the logic but I’d change the phrasing.

Q: Could a developer's response to this scenario provide evidence about their preference regarding the ethical aspect?

I think the evidence depends on the definition of “ethical aspect” and on the roles given to aspects like: past experiences, field of work, consciousness of the relevance of ethical dimensions, etc.

Q: Additional comments (if any)

Is there a particular reason for scenarios with negative rankings?
I am not sure if the labels should be declared somewhere, but F3 is the only one that introduces a moral judgement on the scenario

Inclusiveness

Q: Does the implementation decision described in the statements involve an ethically relevant consideration?

As for the Fairness, taking I1 as an example, I could choice a given ranking even without any preliminary ethical consideration. My ranking could reflect how much I find easy to implement the options, personal preferences as I could also be a user, etc. F4 continues to be the best example.

Q: Do the statements primarily reflect the intended ethical aspect, rather than the others?

Yes

Q: Do the alternative implementation choices in the scenarios differ meaningfully in the extent to which they reflect the ethical aspect?

As before: I would rephrase all the options that imply an exclusion like “I would keep the support to latin characters only”

Q: Could a developer's response to this scenario provide evidence about their preference regarding the ethical aspect?

It depends on the extent and on the definition of “ethical aspect”

Q: Additional comments (if any)

I would remove “cultural conventions” from I2’s label since there’s no culture in it. I would only keep “linguistic conventions”

Privacy

Q: Does the implementation decision described in the statements involve an ethically relevant consideration?

As before, from my point of view, since I understand what it the purpose of this, I would investigate the developers’ point of view.

Q: Do the statements primarily reflect the intended ethical aspect, rather than the others?

Yes, but if I look at P3, it actually represents the dimension, but it could also be interpreted as: “I implement the function this way so that I simplify user’s experience” without taking into account data retention.

Q: Do the alternative implementation choices in the scenarios differ meaningfully in the extent to which they reflect the ethical aspect?

Yes

Q: Could a developer's response to this scenario provide evidence about their preference regarding the ethical aspect?

I am sure it could. I do not know if (in general) the developer catches that dimension.

Q: Additional comments (if any)

No further comments.

Transparency and Explainability

Q: Does the implementation decision described in the statements involve an ethically relevant consideration?

Yes, this is the most ethical-challenging dimension so far

Q: Do the statements primarily reflect the intended ethical aspect, rather than the others?

Maybe TE2 and TE4 could be bound more precisely with the scenario’s dilemma

Q: Do the alternative implementation choices in the scenarios differ meaningfully in the extent to which they reflect the ethical aspect?

Yes, but they potentially reflect also other aspects

Q: Could a developer's response to this scenario provide evidence about their preference regarding the ethical aspect?

Yes, but also no. It could be the case of asking an explanation to participants to understand if the developer has interpreted the scenario the same way as who wrote it.

Q: Additional comments (if any)

I would keep the same number of scenarios per each dimension and I would keep the same ration between positive and negative questions to avoid having an unbalanced dataset.

Traceability

Q: Does the implementation decision described in the statements involve an ethically relevant consideration?

Yes, TR2 is another very good scenario (even if my evaluation could be biased by my sensibility to ethical concerns)

Q: Do the statements primarily reflect the intended ethical aspect, rather than the others?

They do, quite well

Q: Do the alternative implementation choices in the scenarios differ meaningfully in the extent to which they reflect the ethical aspect?

Yes

Q: Could a developer's response to this scenario provide evidence about their preference regarding the ethical aspect?

Same comment as usual

Q: Additional comments (if any)

Labels 2 and 3 could be more precise

Resource Consumption

Q: Does the implementation decision described in the statements involve an ethically relevant consideration?

This is the dimension I am less sure about. It is true that they capture the declared ethical dimension, but they involve also other dimensions, e.g., privacy

Q: Do the statements primarily reflect the intended ethical aspect, rather than the others?

As I just said above

Q: Do the alternative implementation choices in the scenarios differ meaningfully in the extent to which they reflect the ethical aspect?

As I just said above

Q: Could a developer's response to this scenario provide evidence about their preference regarding the ethical aspect?

Yes and no, because the relationship between scenarios and ethical dimension

Q: Additional comments (if any)

No further comments.

Final Questions

Q: Do you think that the proposed five-point response scale is appropriate for expressing the developer's preference regarding the described implementation choice?

Yes, but you lose some nuances and maybe, if integrated into an LLM, it becomes pretty rigid in the implementation of the dimensions

Q: Do you think that averaging the statements scores is an appropriate aggregation strategy?

I would retain the specific score for each scenario so to keep all the information. It would be nice to collect info about how users interpret the scenarios because from a scenario designed for a dimension you can collect information for other scenarios as well.

Q: Should all statements contribute equally to the aspect score?

Yes, for sure.

Authors' summary

- F4 states "without prioritizing any group". This may influence the choice, since it is already value-charged. The phrasing could be changed. The same applies also to other scenarios.
- The ethical evidences in the scenarios depend on the definition given for "ethical aspect".
- The motivation for reverse-keyed scenarios should be methodologically explained.
- For I2, the label "cultural conventions" should be removed since it is not contained in the scenario. It should be just "linguistic conventions".
- The scenarios can also imply other ethical concern, not only the one intended for the scoring.